

Chapter 83-2

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Xu Qingzhu asked for the location of their gathering, grabbed an umbrella from the entryway, and went downstairs.

It was a twenty-minute drive from the residential complex to there.

By the time she arrived, the restaurant was mostly empty. Only three or four of the colleagues who had been dining with Liang Shi remained, all of them drunk and dizzy.

Zhou Li, who had a child with her, hadn't drunk much, so she was in charge of calling designated drivers for these drunk colleagues.

But because of the rain, designated drivers weren't easy to book.

After being busy for quite a while, they finally managed to send all those colleagues off.

Liang Shi was sitting at the dining table, her body lazily leaning against the chair, holding a half-empty beer bottle in her arms. Her face was flushed red, as if covered with a thick layer of rouge.

The little one couldn't stay up that late. Rainbow had long been extremely sleepy and had already taken a nap curled up in a chair nearby. Now she was drowsy-eyed, but upon seeing Xu Qingzhu, she still called out in a milky voice: "Sister Xu."

Xu Qingzhu gently pinched her face. "Sleep when we get home."

Rainbow stood up and rubbed her eyes, trying to drive away the sleepiness, but the moment her short little legs jumped down from the chair, her knees buckled and she almost fell.

Xu Qingzhu's quick hands caught her.

Rainbow was in the middle of a yawn, her grape-purple eyes brimming with tears, looking adorably silly.

It was only at times like this that one would feel she was just like other children.

She pouted aggrievedly, let out a soft whine, and mumbled: "So sleepy."

Zhou Li immediately picked her up. "We're going home right away, baby. Can you sleep in the car?"

Rainbow buried her head in Zhou Li's neck and responded softly: "Okay."

Zhou Li looked slender, but she could effortlessly carry Rainbow, who weighed several dozen jin¹, while maintaining even breathing as she spoke with Xu Qingzhu. "Then please take Xiao Liang back. I'm really sorry about tonight. This was supposed to be a farewell party for Xiao Liang, but everyone got carried away and got her drunk. Thank you for coming to pick her up."

"It's fine." Xu Qingzhu smiled faintly. "Take Rainbow home. I'll walk you out."

"No need." Zhou Li declined.

But Xu Qingzhu had already opened the door, smiling: "Let's go."

Zhou Li carried Rainbow, walking steadily the whole way, while Xu Qingzhu held the umbrella for them.

Fine, dense rain threads drifted at an angle under the umbrella. Rainbow nestled in Zhou Li's arms and mumbled: "It's raining."

"Yes." Zhou Li answered gently.

Xu Qingzhu opened the back seat door, and Zhou Li placed Rainbow on the car seat. Rainbow still fought off her sleepiness to say goodbye to Xu Qingzhu: "Bye-bye, Sister Xu."

"Goodbye." Xu Qingzhu closed the car door, and Zhou Li thanked her again.

By the time she saw Zhou Li off, Xu Qingzhu's back was already wet from the rain.

To keep the little one from getting rained on, the umbrella's edge had been tilted toward herself the whole time.

Scattered raindrops pattered onto her back, falling unexpectedly, soaking her clothes and making them stick to her body uncomfortably.

But Xu Qingzhu hadn't thought that much about it at the time. She tugged at the fabric at her shoulders to loosen the shirt underneath, which made her feel slightly better.

She hurried back to the restaurant. A few staff members were whispering among themselves, and some had taken out their phones to sneak photos.

Who knows if they captured anything—anyway, when they saw Xu Qingzhu come in, they hastily put away their phones.

The target who had almost been secretly photographed was lazily nestled in a chair, the corners of her lips curved in just the right arc, those beautiful eyes crinkled in a smile, hugging the beer bottle and refusing to let go.

Xu Qingzhu walked over and patted her shoulder. Her cool, clear voice was tinged with the bite of the autumn wind outside: "Liang Shi, time to go."

Liang Shi frowned and looked up at her, but squinted because the light stung her eyes. "You....."

Her voice after drinking too much was somewhat muffled and hoarse. After saying just one word, her throat felt uncomfortable, and her brow furrowed even tighter.

Her brown hair had completely fallen loose. She was wearing only a light blue shirt, with one button at the collar undone, revealing her delicate collarbone that connected to her beautiful jawline. The skin in that area was tinged with a tender pink.

They had eaten spicy food for dinner, so even her lip color was a deep red, with traces of alcohol still remaining on her lips, shimmering under the light.

Xu Qingzhu extended two fingers and pinched her neck. Liang Shi let out a soft whimper, shrank her neck, and smiled charmingly: "Don't....."

Xu Qingzhu bent down, and the long hair tucked behind her ear fell forward. "Liang Shi, give me the bottle."

The tips of her hair, carrying a fresh orange scent, happened to brush past Liang Shi's nose. She sniffed lightly, her voice lowered, and smiled dazedly: "Your hair smells just like my wife's."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

She really was drunk.

Xu Qingzhu didn't bother arguing with a drunk. She went to take the beer bottle from Liang Shi's arms, but Liang Shi desperately protected it, even moving the bottle in the other direction to avoid her reach.

The remaining half bottle of liquid sloshed and swayed in the bottle, and a few drops splashed directly onto Xu Qingzhu.

The most noticeable was the drop on her neck, teetering on the edge of falling.

The icy sensation made Xu Qingzhu uncomfortable. She was about to raise her hand to wipe it off when Liang Shi said in a low voice: "Don't move."

That voice carried the hoarseness of intoxication, making one's heart itch.

Liang Shi slowly raised her neck, approaching Xu Qingzhu's neck. Her scorching breath spilled entirely onto Xu Qingzhu's skin, burning her until her whole body stiffened.

Xu Qingzhu didn't know what she was going to do.

The next second, that warm tongue tip lightly traced across the skin of her neck, nimbly and deftly licking away that drop of alcohol, leaving behind a patch of moisture.

Liang Shi swallowed the liquid, then raised her hand, her fingertip gently wiping over that moist patch from before.

She looked at Xu Qingzhu with a dazed smile and said softly: "Smells so good."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

She was lost for a moment.

A moment later, Xu Qingzhu regained her senses and pinched Liang Shi's waist. The pain made Liang Shi frown: "It hurts....."

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her sideways. "Come home with me."

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, lowered her eyes, her tone dropping, sounding unhappy:
"Oh."

Xu Qingzhu thought she was actually going to obediently put down the beer bottle, but instead she hugged it and started gulping it down.

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Liang Shi's light brown pupils made her look like a cunning little fox.

She said: "Just let me finish this little bit."

Footnotes:

¹ **Jin (斤)**: A traditional Chinese unit of weight. One jin equals 500 grams or approximately 1.1 pounds. "Several dozen jin" would mean roughly 20-40+ pounds (10-20+ kg), which is a typical weight for a young child.